

# HackSoc

Minutes for June 26, 2019

**Present:** Velvet (Chair), Aaron, Alexi, Alfie, Vanja, Jordan, Gisela

## margins 2019 retrospective

### 1. Deliver After Action Review - AD

Link to AAR - <https://hacksoc.net/margins-aar>

### 2. SWOT Analysis - AD

#### Strengths

Venue was really good - Gender Neutral Toilets, Lots of space

Atmosphere of the event was very positive - cosy

Speakers were all very good. Engaging talks, relevant topics.

#### Weakness

We had 50% attrition

Running event out of term may have affected turnout

Over provisioning of food and swag

Self-care workshop (afternoon) had a lot of drop outs - only a few attendees

#### Opportunities

Lots of space to grow in the venue

This year was successful so we can build on top of it

Amy's talk saved us from a dropped-out speaker

#### Threats

Due Diligence with Scholarships - £112 of scholarship issued to a potentially fraudulent application

Due Diligence with suppliers (Caterer fell through, two swag suppliers were defunct)  
*Aim for convenience not localness with swag suppliers, they all outsource anyways*

Speaker drop out - Contingencies were already there to an extent

Organising practices for the event should be formalised and document to avoid bus factor in the future - perhaps in the HackSoc internal Wiki

### 3. Preparation

Issues with suppliers were handled well, replaced promptly

Getting PLI, Food Safety Certificate should be one of the first things to get from caterers

HackSoc's policy for caterers is nothing more than a quote negotiated prior to receipt of all required documentation - If caterer wants your business or is worth your time they'll be prompt

Volunteers used effectively outside of the event - Preparing swag, food etc.

Speakers/Workshop Leaders Getting designated team member was positive feedback

Risk assessment/Health and Safety Concerns - AO

[Hot Water Urn, Non-individual coffee, fresh produce] these are all high-risk activities that weren't in the risk assessment

SU is turning Health and Safety training into an online Moodle course for 2019/20, this should be reviewed by organisers for next year

Some incidents where lead-times were too tight, e.g. roller banners, caterer, hats

#### 4. During the Event

Issues with Estates/Security was handled well and promptly

Catering location changed for the better

Over-loaded with volunteers

Lots of idle time

Issues with volunteers cliquing (specifically HackSoc volunteers)

Catering went well

Extra portions at lunch are an unknown contributor to positive feedback

Final position of food was more optimal than originally planned

Terrance access was popular

Schedule Changes - VS

People didn't necessarily know who the sponsors were, how to interact with them

Sponsors were put in corners - Refinitiv away from the rest of the venue

Heavy attrition after lunch

Lunch was too long

In future it may make sense to make lunch 30 minutes (split in two slots?)

Weren't enough activities for people to do/mingle around during lunch

#### 5. Recommendations

Marketing Language - VS

Some people didn't comfortable identifying themselves as marginalised, changing the language may be worthwhile.

Pre-event communication

Better communicate

Finances/Surplus Funds

Would have been good to inform applicable individuals about opportunities to expense local travel after the event

Delay paying speakers until after Refinitiv money has cleared

Look into what is owed to Amy from WiT17 and reimburse

Invest most excess funds into future margins/inspireWiT

Investigation into errant travel scholarship

Post mortem will be distributed and added to the HackSoc Internal Wiki

## 6. Next Steps - Future margins

Re-use of existing document and forms - VS

Code of Conduct can be re-used for next year

Catering next year - Perhaps use one of the local caterers already involved in BME

Refinitiv has expressed wanting to work together on further workshop and activities in this space

Clarify zero-tolerance policy on intolerance

Should 2020 be bigger?

Should continue to aim for 100 attendees

We should keep the cosy feel of the event

April 2020? That way it is still nice out but it's also during term

Make some sort of crafting thing to do that get's made as a group in the space

Catering

Juicy Jackets was not first choice, presumably this will hold true in the future

Breakfast - Lots of people went after the bars and not fruit (perhaps because we're approaching an age where people don't like eating an orange in public)

Swag

We had a lot more swag than needed, most can be reused to an extent

Bags - felt a bit wasteful when putting stuff away at the end - perhaps a stack of swag as a solution in future

Some better communication about "taking a bag" would help resolve the large amount of them left over

Volunteer Hats

They didn't fit particularly

Should keep the head idea (Bandanna, Visor, Beanie?)

People were too comfortable to take them off indoors

Speakers

Have a better way to notify speakers when they have five minutes remaining etc.

Target Audiences in future

Women in Tech Community

BME Communities

Latinx?

Not all groups like using negative (marginalised/discriminated against) language, because they can be more about empowerment

Expanding the "work with concept" to avoid exclusivity of those that aren't in designated "tech jobs"

## Marketting

Make it clearer that it's not just for people who work in Tech

Frame vegan free food as just free food

Using photos on marketing materials

Promote free food more in general